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Search Committee
Department of Economics
University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill
Chapel Hill, NC 27514
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Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to express my interest in the Open Rank tenure-track faculty position in the Department of Economics at UNC-Chapel Hill. I am a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University, advised by Professors Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis, and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My research fields are macroeconomics, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics.

My research agenda focuses on understanding the determinants of wealth inequality and the mechanisms through which heterogeneity in returns to wealth shapes aggregate outcomes. In my job-market paper, I estimate the degree of heterogeneity in individual portfolio returns using micro-data from the Survey of Consumer Finances and simulate a structural model in which households face idiosyncratic return risk. I show that allowing for persistent heterogeneity in returns substantially improves the model's ability to match the empirical distribution of wealth, offering a tractable way to connect micro-level return dispersion to macroeconomic inequality.

In a second project, I use the Health and Retirement Study to examine the relationship between interpersonal trust and portfolio performance. Building on the literature that finds a hump-shaped relationship between trust and income, I show that a similar relationship holds for individual returns to wealth measured in the HRS data, highlighting a behavioral channel through which social attitudes shape saving and investment outcomes. This work also provides new estimates of the persistent component of returns to net worth, which motivate the calibration of heterogeneity in my structural model.

UNC-Chapel Hill's Department of Economics is a world-leading research department with rich strengths in macroeconomics, econometrics, public economics, and quantitative methods. The opportunity to collaborate with scholars engaged in structural macro modeling, policy evaluation, and empirical methods is highly appealing to me. In particular, I look forward to engaging with initiatives such as the Carolina Population Center and the Department's strong network of applied macro and finance researchers. I am eager to contribute to your mission of advancing top-tier scholarship while mentoring students and contributing to departmental governance and service.

Teaching. My teaching experience centers on undergraduate macroeconomics and an upper-level macro policy seminar, where I have led weekly discussion sections and held regular office hours for classes ranging from 16 to 40 students. My approach is student-centered: I aim to help students "convince themselves" that they have moved from confusion to understanding by holding structured

office-hour coaching that builds trust and confidence. At UNC Chapel Hill I am prepared to teach *Principles of Macroeconomics*, *Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory*, *Money and Banking*, and *Quantitative Methods for Economics*. I would also welcome developing electives such as *Economics of Inequality and Tax Policy* or *Computational Macroeconomics and Policy*, emphasizing reproducible workflows and evidence-based decision-making.

I believe I would be a strong fit because my computational and empirical toolkit allows me to (i) produce robust, data-backed estimates of returns and distributional outcomes, (ii) build and validate models that speak to macroeconomic and policy-relevant questions, and (iii) collaborate across research teams and engage both undergraduate and graduate students in research and teaching. I am enthusiastic about the opportunity to join UNC-Chapel Hill's Department of Economics and to contribute to its research, teaching, and service missions.

I would be honored to join your faculty at the University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill and to contribute to the Department of Economics. Thank you for your consideration; I welcome the opportunity to discuss my fit with your department at your convenience.

Sincerely,

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